

SECURITY OPERATIONS CENTER

INCIDENT REPORT — PHISHING EMAIL / MALICIOUS LINK CLICK

Incident ID	SOC-INC-2026-0231	Classification	TLP:AMBER — Internal Use Only
Detected	18 September 2026, 09:14 UTC	Reported	18 September 2026, 09:20 UTC
Reporting Analyst	J. Ortiz — SOC Tier 1 Analyst	Reviewing Analyst	SOC Lead
Severity	Medium	Priority	P3
Status	Resolved / Closed	Category	Phishing — Malicious Link Click

1. Summary

An employee clicked a malicious link in a payment-themed phishing email but did not enter credentials. The malicious URL was blocked at the corporate web proxy, and the phishing email was removed from all identified mailboxes.

2. Detection Details

Detection Source	Employee report via Outlook "Report Phishing", corroborated by Microsoft Defender for Office 365
Alert Name	Phishing-Link-Click-Detected
Detection Time	18 September 2026, 09:18 UTC
Email Delivery	18 September 2026, 09:14 UTC
Spoofed Sender	billing-support@invoice-secure-payments[.]net
Subject	Urgent: Invoice Payment Required – Action Needed
Malicious URL	hxxp://secure-invoice-payments[.]net/login
Security Tools	Microsoft Defender for Office 365; Zscaler Web Proxy; Proofpoint TAP

3. Affected Assets

Asset Type	Identifier	Impact / Notes
Endpoint	MKT-PC-07	Workstation used to open the email and click the malicious link.
User Account	lchen (L. Chen)	Marketing user; reported the email and did not submit credentials.
Mailboxes	5 total	Original recipient plus four additional recipients received the same message.
Network Egress Point	Zscaler Web Proxy	Corporate gateway where the malicious URL was blocked.

4. Timeline — UTC

Time (UTC)	Event
09:14	Phishing email delivered to lchen's mailbox and bypassed initial filtering.
09:16	User clicked the embedded link; a fake invoice-login page loaded.
09:17	User confirmed no credentials were entered, closed the browser tab, and reported the email.
09:18	Microsoft Defender correlation rule fired and the SIEM alert was generated.
09:20	Tier 1 analyst acknowledged the alert and opened ticket SOC-INC-2026-0231.
09:25	URL reputation was confirmed and the malicious URL was added to the Zscaler blocklist.
09:28	Retroactive mailbox search identified the same phishing email in four additional inboxes.
09:32	Phishing email was purged from all five affected mailboxes.
09:40	EDR scan of MKT-PC-07 completed; no malware or persistence mechanisms found.
09:50	lchen's account was placed under 24-hour enhanced sign-in monitoring; no anomalous logins observed.
10:05	Incident closed as True Positive — Contained.

5. Investigation Steps

1. Reviewed email headers and sender-authentication results; SPF and DKIM checks failed for the spoofed domain.
2. Checked the malicious URL against urlscan.io and VirusTotal and confirmed a credential-harvesting page mimicking a payment portal.
3. Reviewed Zscaler proxy logs to verify the web request was blocked and found no evidence of data submission from MKT-PC-07.
4. Searched corporate mailboxes for the same sender, subject, and URL; four additional recipients were identified and remediated.
5. Performed an EDR scan on MKT-PC-07 to check for malware download or persistence; the endpoint was clean.
6. Reviewed Azure AD sign-in logs for Ichen's account for the following 24 hours; no unusual locations, devices, or authentication activity were observed.

6. Classification

Classification	True Positive — Phishing (Link Click, No Credential Compromise)
Severity	Medium
Justification	The user interacted with a confirmed malicious link, establishing phishing engagement risk. However, no credentials

7. Actions Taken

- Blocked the malicious URL at the Zscaler web proxy.
- Purged the phishing email from all five affected mailboxes using Microsoft 365 Security & Compliance Center.
- Performed an EDR scan on MKT-PC-07; no indicators of compromise were identified.
- Placed Ichen's account under 24-hour enhanced sign-in monitoring as a precaution.
- Notified the employee's manager and the Security Awareness team.

8. Recommendations

- Add the sender domain, malicious URL, and associated indicators to organization-wide email and web-proxy blocklists.
- Provide a targeted phishing-awareness refresher for the affected user and the wider Marketing team, focusing on invoice/payment-themed lures.
- Review inbound email filtering rules to determine why the message bypassed initial phishing/spam controls.
- Run a follow-up phishing simulation focused on invoice/payment lures to measure awareness and reporting effectiveness.
- Review DMARC enforcement for look-alike domains used to impersonate internal billing communications.

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

Type	Value
Malicious URL	hxxp://secure-invoice-payments[.]net/login
Sender Domain	invoice-secure-payments[.]net
Sender Address	billing-support@invoice-secure-payments[.]net
Alert Name	Phishing-Link-Click-Detected

Analyst Notes: No prior reports involving the sender domain were identified in the available threat-intelligence checks at the time of analysis. The domain was submitted for takedown review. Future alerts should be cross-checked against the domain and related infrastructure.

Prepared by: J. Ortiz, SOC Tier 1 Analyst **Reviewed by:** SOC Lead